

# The Fraudulent Medium

Nerve +2 | Notice +3 | Rapport +4 | Reason +1 | Vigor +0

You are **The Fraudulent Medium**. You make a living pretending to speak with the dead. Outwardly, you perform with absolute confidence; privately, you believe you are a fraud who has mistaken instinct and coincidence for something more. But once - and only once - you had a vision you could not explain. You saw Mourning Bluff Manor, including details you later confirmed had never been made public. You have come to the house grasping for proof that the vision was real and that perhaps you have not been pretending all this time.

## WHAT IS ESTABLISHED

Your public career depends on presenting uncertainty as supernatural certainty. Most of your work uses performance, observation, research, and cold reading. The vision of the manor was different, and no explanation you have tried has accounted for it. Your name, age, gender, appearance, occupation, relationships, and personal history are yours unless established above. Your name, age, gender, appearance, occupation, relationships, and personal history are yours unless established above.

## MAKE THE CHARACTER YOUR OWN

Create your stage persona and decide how famous, successful, or desperate you are. You might be a theatrical entertainer, a private grief counselor with questionable methods, a television personality, a social-media psychic, or a small-time reader working fairs and parlors. Decide whether you feel guilty about the comfort you sell, proud that it helps people, or terrified that a genuine gift would make every lie unforgivable.

## DECIDE BEFORE PLAY

- What detail from the vision could you never have learned normally?
- What performance technique do you rely on when you feel cornered?
- Who have you genuinely helped despite the deception?

## WEAKNESS: NEVER BREAK CHARACTER

*If I admit uncertainty, everyone will see me for the fraud I really am.*

If you openly admit that you may be a fraud, retract a supernatural claim, or confess that you do not know what your vision means, put the three visible cards on the bottom of your deck in any order. Then draw three new cards and keep them facedown.

Play those cards blindly from the top of your deck. Until all three have been played, they remain facedown. Then reveal the next three cards and resume using The Sight normally.

## GIFT: THE SIGHT

*I saw this house before I knew it existed; that has to mean something.*

Keep the top three cards of your deck faceup in order. Everyone may see them, but only the topmost card is your active Premonition and only that card may be played or discarded.

Whenever the active card leaves your deck, the second card becomes active and you reveal another card so that three are visible again.

Seeing a Major among the three cards does not activate it. It activates only when it reaches the top.

## TOOL: SÉANCE BELL

*You carry a small brass séance bell with a dark wooden handle worn smooth by years of use. Bells like this are traditionally placed on séance tables so spirits can announce their presence or answer questions by ringing without a living hand touching them.*

Place the bell on a stable surface, ask a yes-or-no question aloud, and ring it once. If a spirit in the room chooses to answer, the bell rings once for yes or twice for no without being touched. Silence means that no answer was given. The response comes from the spirit, not the GM, and the spirit may lie, misunderstand the question, or have incomplete knowledge.

## SECRET

Create a Secret that your character must hide from the rest of the group. It should be something that could cause conflict if the others discovered it.

## QUICK PLAY REFERENCE

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| <p><b>Tests.</b> Use your active Premonition, add the named Stat, and compare the total with the Difficulty. Beat it by 3 for a clean success; meet it or beat it by 1-2 for success with a consequence; below it fails.</p> <p><b>Minor cards.</b> Ace: critical success and regain 1 Grounding. Page 11. Knight 12. Queen: automatic success and lose 1 Grounding. King 19.</p> |                                           |                                                 |                                                         |                                                    | <p><b>Major Arcana.</b> A Major is never a test value. It changes the whole house, then every character resets their Premonition.</p> <p><b>Grounding.</b> Begin with 6. At 0, you are Unmoored and draw blindly until an Ace or meaningful help in a place of safety restores you.</p> <p><b>Tools.</b> Use your Tool in any physically reasonable way. No test is needed when it makes the outcome safe and certain.</p> |
| <b>NERVE</b><br>Endurance, courage, and sanity                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>NOTICE</b><br>Perception and awareness | <b>RAPPORT</b><br>Charisma and social influence | <b>REASON</b><br>Intelligence, knowledge, and willpower | <b>VIGOR</b><br>Strength, dexterity, and athletics |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |